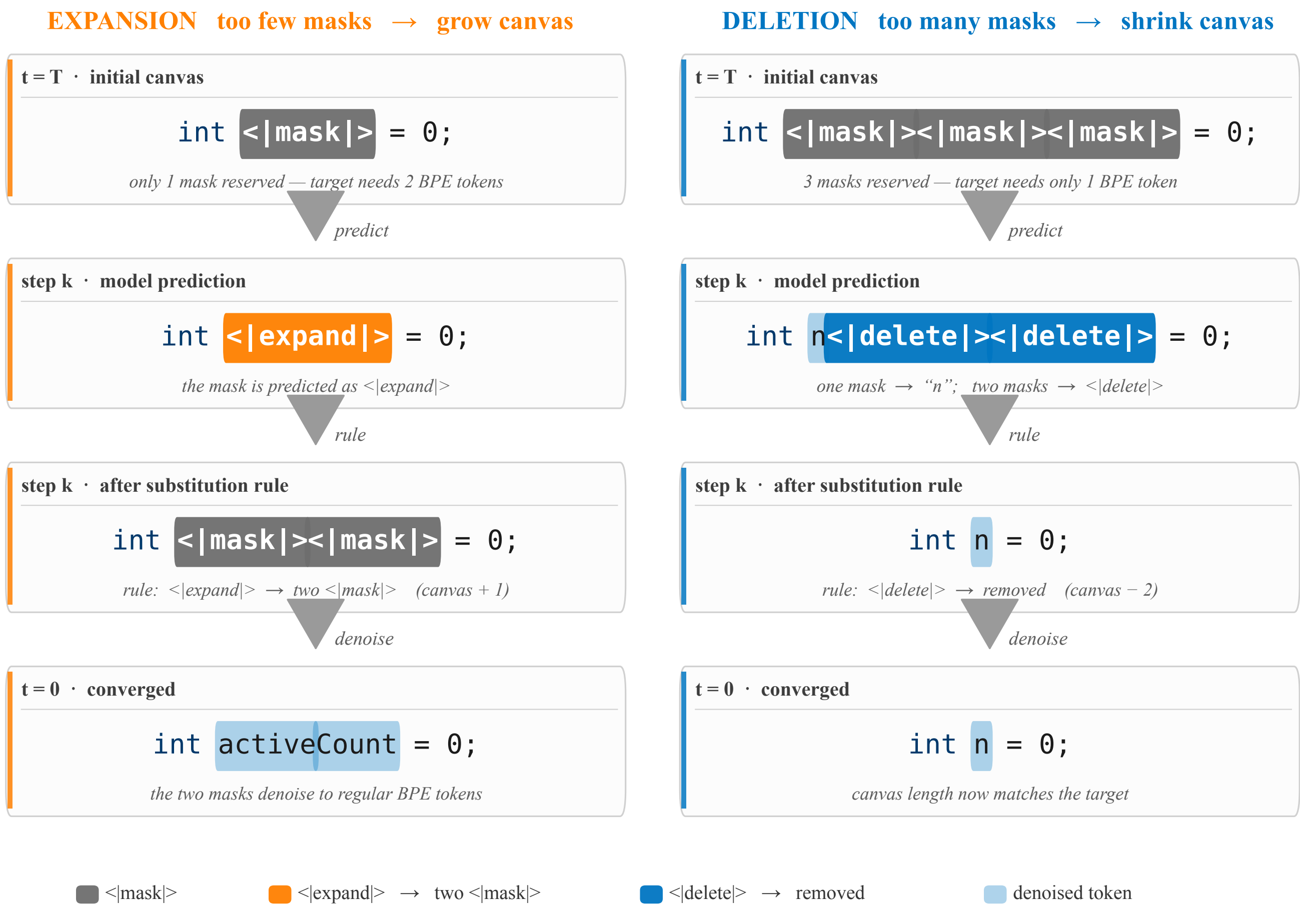

EXPANSION too few masks → grow canvas
t = T · initial canvas
int <|mask|> = 0;
only 1 mask reserved — target needs 2 BPE tokens
predict
step k · model prediction
int <|expand|> = 0;
the mask is predicted as <|expand|>
rule
step k · after substitution rule
int <|mask|><|mask|> = 0;
rule: <|expand|> → two <|mask|> (canvas + 1)
denoise
t = 0 · converged
int activeCount = 0;
the two masks denoise to regular BPE tokens
DELETION too many masks → shrink canvas
t = T · initial canvas
int <|mask|><|mask|><|mask|> = 0;
3 masks reserved — target needs only 1 BPE token
predict
step k · model prediction
int n<|delete|><|delete|> = 0;
one mask → “n”; two masks → <|delete|>
rule
step k · after substitution rule
int n = 0;
rule: <|delete|> → removed (canvas − 2)
denoise
t = 0 · converged
int n = 0;
canvas length now matches the target
<|mask|>
<|expand|> → two <|mask|>
<|delete|> → removed
denoised token